

# MANGU 2025 KCSE PREDICTION



## CONFIDENTIAL EXAM

451/1

## COMPUTER STUDIES

PAPER 1 (THEORY)

TIME: 2½ HOURS



NAME.....

SCHOOL..... SIGN.....

INDEX NO..... ADM NO.....

(Kenya Certificate of Secondary Education)

### INSTRUCTIONS TO CANDIDATES

- (a) Write your Name and Index/Adm Number in the spaces provided.
- (b) This paper consists of TWO sections: A and B
- (c) Answer ALL the questions in section A
- (d) Answer question 16 and any other **THREE** questions from section B
- (e) All answers should be written in the spaces provided in the question paper.

### For Examiners use only.

| Section     | Question | Candidates Score |
|-------------|----------|------------------|
| A           | 1 – 15   |                  |
| B           | 16       |                  |
|             | 17       |                  |
|             | 18       |                  |
|             | 19       |                  |
|             | 20       |                  |
| Total Score |          |                  |

**SECTION A (40 MARKS)**

**ANSWER ALL QUESTIONS FROM THIS SECTION**

1. Give **FOUR** characteristics of first generation computers? (2marks)

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2. a) Why are powder fire extinguishers not allowed in the computer room? (1 mark)

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b) What is the difference between delete and backspace keys? (2 marks)

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3. Give **FOUR** factors that describe the ideal environment for a computer to work properly.

(2marks)

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4. Give **TWO** advantages of using sound output devices (2marks)

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5. Give **TWO** application areas of OMR (2marks)

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6. a) Distinguish between primary and secondary storage devices. (2marks)

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7. State FOUR devices that support multimedia capability on a computer (2marks)

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b) Differentiate between the terms: volatile memory and non-volatile memory. (2marks)

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8. Differentiate between misreading and transposition errors in data processing (2marks)

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9. What is the function of the power supply unit found in the system unit? (2marks)

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10. (a) Name **FOUR** approaches that may be used to replace a Computerized Information system.  
(2 marks)

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(b) Which of the approaches named in (a) above is appropriate for critical systems? Explain.  
(2 marks)

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11. Terry intends to download a movie from the Internet. State the **two** factors that may determine the total time taken to complete the download.  
(2 Marks)

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12. A lecturer keeps the following student details in a database: name, age, course.

(a) Write an expression you would use to compute the year of birth of a student using this year as the current year.  
(2 marks)

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(b) What query expressions would the lecturer use to list the students whose age is above 15 years and below 25 years?  
(2 marks)

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**13. a)** Explain each of the following roles performed by an operating system

**i. Memory management (2 marks)**

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**ii. Interrupt handling ( 2 marks)**

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**14.** A computer teacher has put a rule that flash disk should not be used in the computer laboratory

**(a) Give a reason for the rule (1 mark)**

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**(b) State two alternatives that can be used to achieve the same objective (1 marks)**

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**15. (a) What is a utility software? (1 mark)**

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**(b) Give FOUR examples of utility software (2 marks)**

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## SECTION B (60 MKS)

### Answer question 16 and any other 3 questions.

- 16. a) i)** What is system maintenance? **(2marks)**
- b)** Differentiate between absolute and relative cell referencing. **(2marks)**
- c) The** formula \$A\$4 +C\$5 is typed in cell D4 and copied to cell H6. Write down the formula as it would appear in cell H6. **(2marks)**
- d)** Generate output for the following pseudo code **(4marks)**
- START
- X= 5
- WHILE (X<15) DO
- Y= X +2
- X=X+3
- PRINT X,Y
- ENDWHILE
- PRINT (“DONE’,X)
- STOP
- e)** Draw a flowchart for the above pseudo code **(5 marks)**

- 17. a)** Using 10-bits binary number system, perform the following decimal operation using two's complement. **(4 marks)**

$$129_{10} - 128_{10}$$

- b)** Convert the following into binary 6CD<sub>16</sub> **(2 marks)**
- c)** Perform the following binary arithmetic 11001.101+1110.011 **(2 marks)**
- d)** Define the following terms. **(3 marks)**
- i) Record
- ii) File
- iii) Database

e) List any **FOUR** ways of dealing with a virus on a computer. (4 marks)

**18. a)** Explain the functions performed by (2 marks)

i) The control unit-

ii) Arithmetic and logic unit (ALU)

b) Define the following terms in relation to computer software . (3 marks)

i) Free ware.

ii) Proprietary

iii) Open source

c) i) Define the term E-commerce (2marks)

ii) List down **TWO** advantages of e- commerce as used in modern business environment (2marks)

d) Describe **THREE** ways how computing has been applied to each of the following areas:

i) Reservation systems. (3 marks)

ii) Law enforcement (3 marks)

**19. (a) i)** Name any **TWO** types of non-printable guides in DTP. (1mark)

ii) Explain the functions of each of non-printable guides in (19 (a)i) above (4 marks)

b) State **FOUR** factors to consider when designing a good file (2 marks)

c) Name **THREE** responsibilities that are carried out by a:

(i) Web administrator ( 3 marks)

(ii) Computer trainer (3 marks)

d) Identify **TWO** disadvantages of Observation method used in fact-finding. (2 marks)

**20.(a)** List **THREE** advantages of wireless communication over wired communication. (3 marks)

(b) Using a Diagram, describe the following signals and state where each is applied in network communication:

(i) Analog; (2 marks)

(ii) Digital. (2 marks)

(c) Name the **TWO** types of coaxial cables. (2 marks)

(d) (i) Define the term network protocol. (1 mark)

(e) List **FOUR** internet protocols (2 marks)

(f) Describe star topology as used in networking

**(3 marks)**